Athena Non-Decision Protocol

A Governance-Layer Architecture for Authority Boundary Control

The Emerging Governance Problem

As AI systems become increasingly embedded in operational environments, recommendations
can gradually become operationally indistinguishable from decisions.

This creates a structural governance problem:

Who remains accountable when authority boundaries become unclear?

What Athena Is

Athena is a governance-layer architecture designed to
detect authority boundary overreach in AI-assisted decision systems.

Rather than replacing existing AI systems,
Athena operates as a structural safeguard layer that:

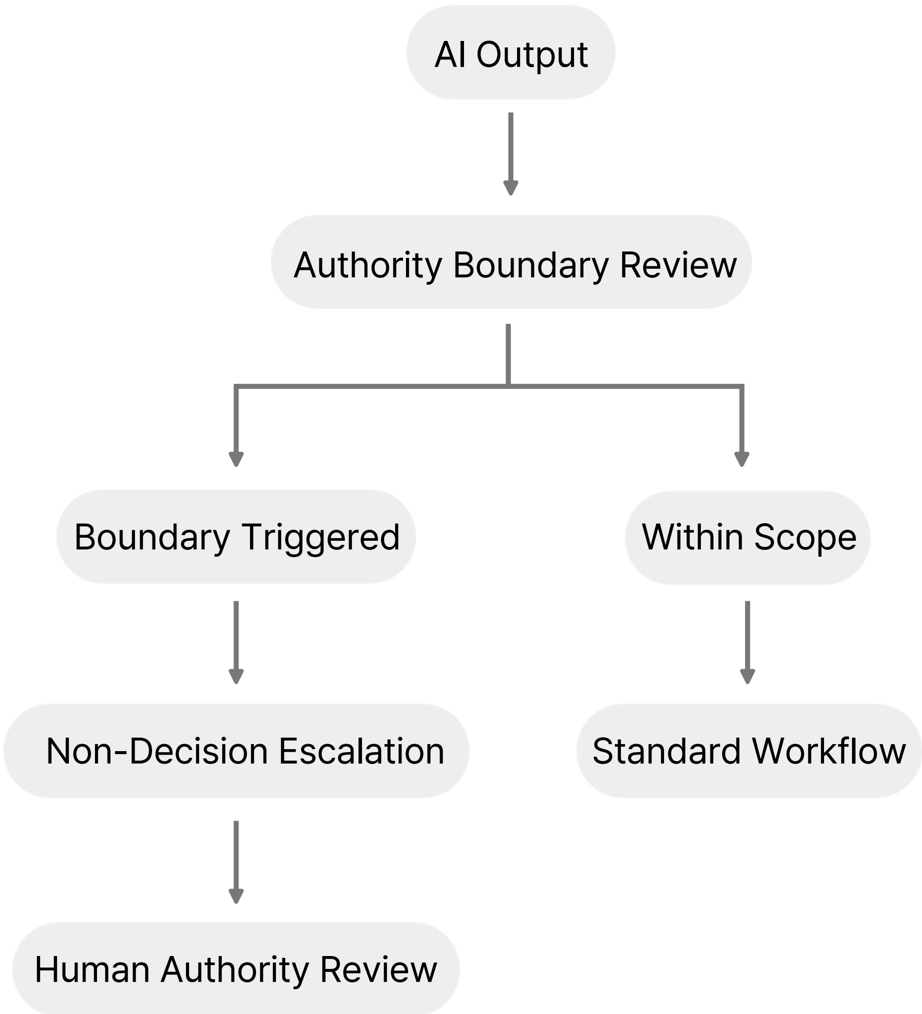
- Detects when AI outputs approach unauthorized decision finalization
- Activates structured non-decision escalation conditions
- Returns authority to designated human operators
- Enables governance logging and accountability traceability

Core Structural Principle

AI systems should not silently inherit decision authority

beyond their explicitly defined operational scope.

Simplified Governance Flow



Closing Statement

Designed for high-risk AI deployment environments

where escalation clarity and accountability integrity are

operationally critical.